▼ GLASSHOUSE



A FRUGAL FLEET

The new **Himanta Biswa Sarma**-led Assam cabinet has decided that some belt tightening is in order, in line with Prime Minister Narendra Modi's calls for austerity measures in the wake of the West Asia crisis. Key to the drive will be the downsizing of the convoys of the governor, chief minister, ministers and senior officials. However, even earlier, Sarma had been operating with a lean convoy, compared to many other chief ministers. Despite being in the Z-plus protection category, his convoy within Guwahati usually had only six vehicles, with no ambulance or jammer vehicle. For trips to districts, which usually entail a larger entourage, Sarma is said to be considering a "caravan-style" transport, which will allow all the officials to travel with him in one large vehicle. The idea, apparently, is to use the travel hours for administrative discussions, saving both time and resources.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ UP'S 'OUTSTANDING MLA'

COMMITTED BACHELOR

Uttar Pradesh chief minister **Yogi Adityanath** often takes light-hearted jibes at the bachelor status of his finance and parliamentary affairs minister, **Suresh Khanna**. At an Ujjwala Yojana event in Lucknow in March, the CM had joked that the septuagenarian Khanna had chosen not to marry so that no one could beat him with a rolling pin if a gas cylinder did not reach home in time. At a book launch in April, he quipped that UP had benefited as it allowed Khanna to devote himself fully to government work. All that dedicated effort has now earned Khanna a formal honour. On May 15, the 73-year-old was named Uttar Pradesh's 'outstanding MLA'. The award cited his legislative experience, knowledge of parliamentary procedure, contribution in the House, and overall conduct and performance. Incidentally, Khanna is a nine-time 'undefeated' legislator from Shahjahanpur.

